

Little Commanders

2–6 players · 30–45 minutes · ages 8+

Rulebook draft v0.3. Working title, art and numbers will change.

1 The Game in One Minute

You are a kid commander with cute little  **Bots** and a few big  **Mechs**. Spread across the hex floor, hold tiles, and complete  **Missions** to earn  **Victory Points**. The first commander to reach the target wins.

Two rules to remember. (1) You spend  Credits to recruit, move and buy Missions. (2) Move onto an enemy tile with enough strength and its defenders must go. Everything else is printed on your board, the tiles and the cards.

2 Icons

The same pictures are used on tiles, cards, boards and in this book.

	Credit		Iron		Crystal
	Bot (power 1)		Mech (power 5)		Victory Point
	Extractor		Factory		Guard Tower
	Dock		Port		Mission card
	Move (1 per step)		Push		Kill
	Income		Trade		Used this turn
	Tile		Centre tile		Control a tile
	Price goes up		Price goes down		Road

3 Components

- **Tiles:** 37 land tiles, 6 Home tiles, 12 Port tiles (Ports only in the Advanced game).
- **Boards:** 6 Commander boards (Basic side and Advanced side), 1 Market board (Advanced game).
- **Per commander:** 20 Bots, 6 Mechs, 5 Extractors, 5 Factories, 5 Guard Towers, 1 Dock.
- **Tokens:** Iron, Crystal, Credit coins (1, 5, 10), price markers, VP markers.
- **Cards:** 40 Missions (20 of Level 1, 20 of Level 2).

4 Basic or Advanced

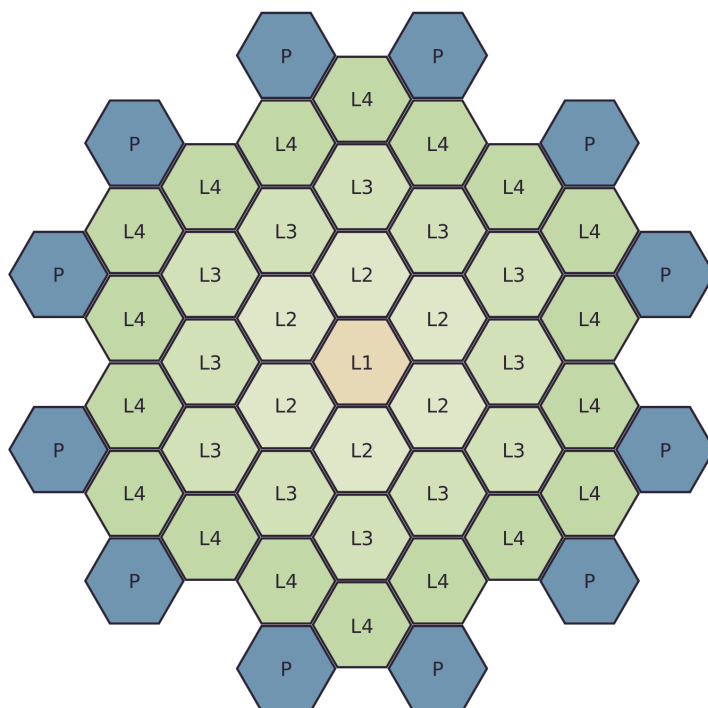
There are two ways to play. Both use the same board, pieces and Missions.

Basic	Production,  Mechs, combat and  Missions. Moving costs 1 Credit per step. No Docks, Ports or market.
Advanced	Everything in Basic, plus  Docks,  Ports and the  market with moving prices. Moving uses the triangular cost (1, 3, 6, 10 Credits for 1 to 4 steps), so slow movement is cheaper per step.

On BGA this is the *Rules* game option. Use the Basic side of your board for Basic, the Advanced side for Advanced.

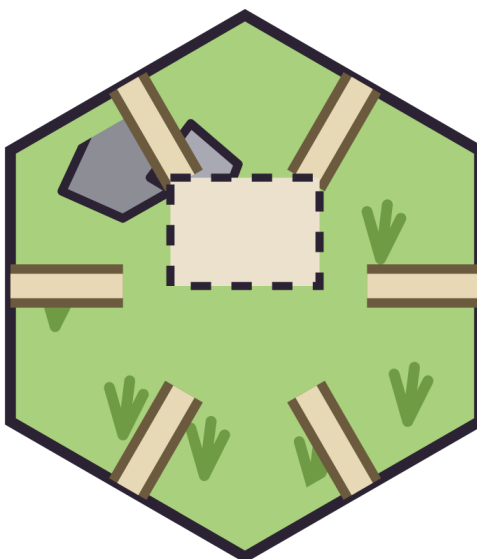
5 Setup

1. **Build the floor.** 2–3 players: 19 land tiles (centre and 2 rings). 4–6 players: 37 land tiles (centre and 3 rings). Shuffle the tiles of each ring and place them at random, then check that you can walk from the centre to every tile over roads that *both* touching tiles show (re-deal if not).
2. **Homes.** Space the Home tiles evenly on the outer ring. Each player takes the one in their colour with  **3 Bots**, a  Guard Tower and  **2 Iron**.
3. **Ports** (Advanced). Place 2 Port tiles per player around the outside, each beside 2 land tiles, and give every player a  Dock on their home tile.
4. **Missions.** Reveal 5 Missions from a deck of Level 1 cards with Level 2 cards below. Basic leaves out the Port cards.
5. **Market** (Advanced). Put each price marker at random in its starting band: Iron 4–7, Bots 4–7, Crystal 8–14, Mechs 8–14.



Four to six players: 37 land tiles and 12 Ports (shown schematically; L = land level, P = port).

6 Reading a Tile



Everything you need is printed on the tile itself.

- **Ground:** green  Iron mine, blue  Crystal deposit, grey empty tile, or a green tile with both resources.
- **Sockets:** 0, 1 or 2 square building areas where you may build.
- **Roads:** a road on an edge means this tile connects there. A tiny broken stump means no road. Pieces only travel where *both* tiles show a road.
- **Ports** (Advanced): show the good and a  (2 cheaper to buy) or  (3 more when you sell).

Tiles nearer the centre have more roads. The  centre has all six. Letters and numbers around the board name every tile; the game log uses the same names.

7 Your Turn

At the start of your turn gain  **10 Credits** and take the coins off your buildings. Then do any of the following, in any order. End your turn when you are done. Your attacks are decided then.

Control

You  **control** a tile while at least one of your pieces stands on it. Buildings and tokens on a tile belong to whoever controls it. Bots cannot be assigned to anything; they hold tiles and attack.

Build and Make

Spend iron that is standing on the tile on a free socket there. Build your first Extractor with your starting Iron.

	Extractor	Once per turn, pay 1 Credit: take 1 token of the tile's resource.	1 
	Factory	Once per turn, pay 1 Credit: 1  becomes 2  , or 1  + 1 	2 
	Guard Tower	Makes the tile harder to push and kill.	2 

When a building works, put a  coin on it. Take the coins back at the start of your turn. You may sell a building: it returns to your board and you get its cost minus 1 Iron on the tile. Resource tokens belong to whoever holds the tile; carry them with your pieces (they pay like pieces when they move).

Move

→ **Basic:** every step costs 1 Credit per piece. **Advanced:** a piece pays 1, 3, 6, 10 Credits in total for 1, 2, 3, 4 steps this turn, minus what it already paid, so a piece that keeps going only pays the difference. Pieces follow open roads and cannot pass through enemy pieces. Put a coin under a piece that has moved this turn.

Trade (Advanced)

↔ Stand on a tile with your  Dock or on a  Port. Each post trades once per turn: pay 1 Credit, then choose one good and buy or sell any number of it at the current price.

- **Home Dock:** Iron and Bots, at the normal price.
- **Port:** one good is 2 cheaper to buy, or pays 3 more when sold.
- Afterwards the price moves one step for every item traded:  when you buy,  when you sell. A step is 1 Credit for Iron and Bots and 2 for Crystal and Mechs.
- Ranges: Iron 1–10, Bots 1–10, Crystal 2–20, Mechs 2–20.

Missions

Pay  **5 Credits** to buy a face-up Mission, plus 1 for every Mission you have bought. You may buy one per turn. If you meet it *at that moment*, you score its  (1 for Level 1 cards, 2 for Level 2 cards). If not, the Credits are lost. A completed card is replaced from the deck.



Combat

Move onto an enemy tile to attack it. Attackers walk in; the attack is decided when you end your turn.

-  Bot power 1.  Mech power 5. Add up each side's power.
-  **Push:** attackers have at least $2\times$ the defenders' power. The defenders retreat; the defending player chooses where each piece goes.
-  **Kill:** at least $3\times$. The defenders are removed.
-  Each Guard Tower on the tile adds 1 to both multipliers ($2 \rightarrow 3$, $3 \rightarrow 4$, ...).
- Not enough? The attack **fails** and the attackers return to where they came from.

Winning

Be first to 5  Victory Points. Points come only from Missions.

8 Factions

Each commander has a colour and a different silhouette, so the game also works without colour vision. Faction powers are an optional extra still being designed.

9 Your Board

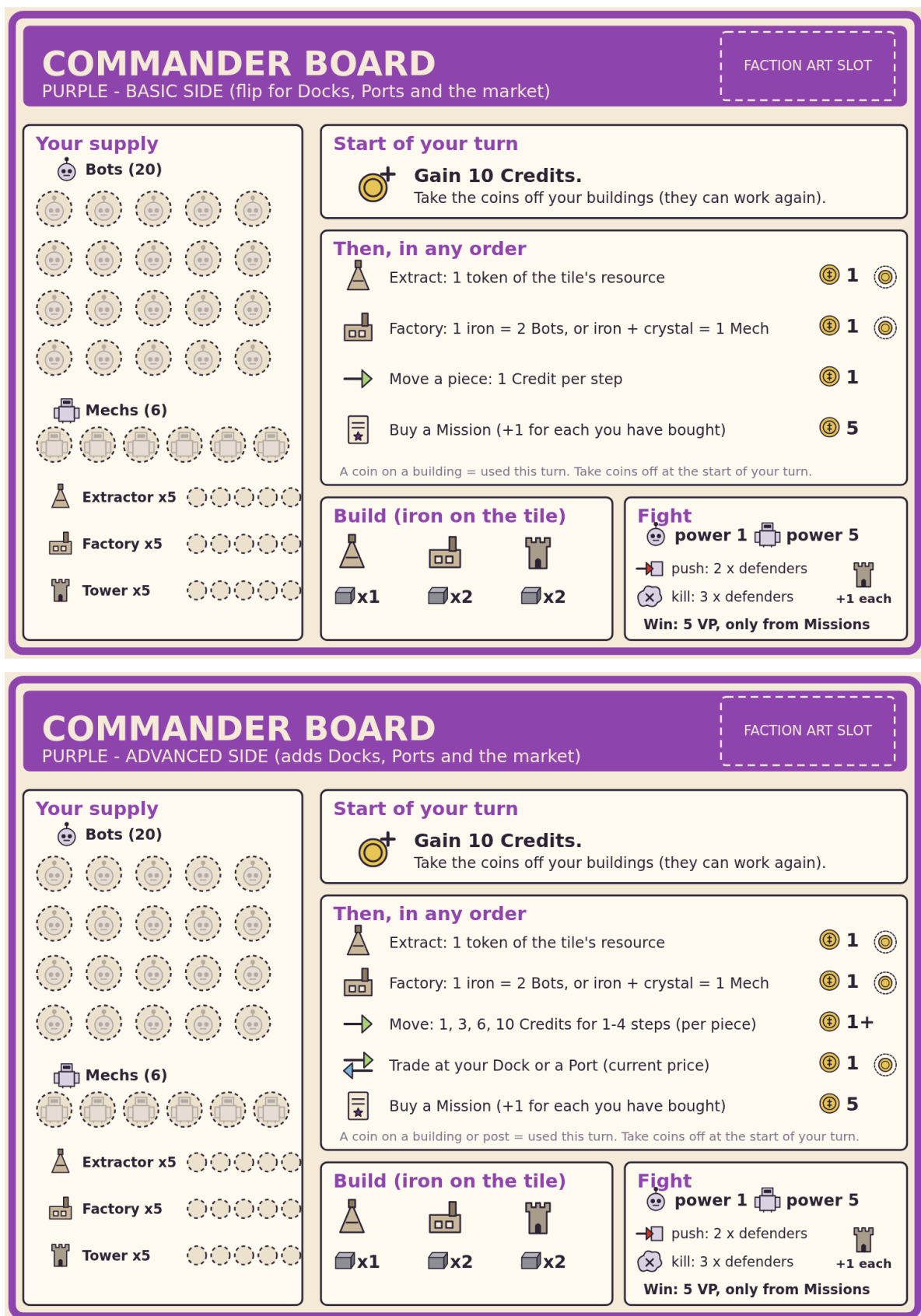


Figure 1: Basic side (front) and Advanced side (back).

10 Draft Notes

- Income is a flat 10 Credits. Movement is linear in Basic and triangular in Advanced; see `DESIGN_NOTES.md`.
- The market still prices a whole trade at today's price before moving, so big buy-and-sell loops between a Dock and a Port can print Credits. Needs per-item price steps or fixed port prices.